

D174

Marketing Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A mid-sized outdoor-gear company that sells in 18 countries has already chosen young urban commuters as its customer group. It now wants those buyers to see its backpacks as the most durable option at a fair price, compared with rival brands. Its ad agency is based in Portland. Which STP step is this?

- A. Segmentation.
- B. Positioning.
- C. Advertising strategy set by the agency.
- D. Targeting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A streaming service sorts all potential viewers into groups by age, household type and viewing habits before deciding whom to serve. Which STP step is this?

- A. Targeting.
- B. Positioning.
- C. Segmentation.
- D. Market research.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A snack brand with a new mango flavor decides to sell through convenience stores and vending machines instead of large grocery chains. Its founder started the company in a college dorm. Which element of the marketing mix is this decision?

- A. Product, because of the new mango flavor.
- B. Price.
- C. Promotion.
- D. Place.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Sales of a smart-ring fitness tracker rose 80% this year, several new competitors entered, and the maker turned its first profit. The product comes in four colors. Which life-cycle stage is it in, and what strategy fits?

- A. Maturity; cut prices to defend share.
- B. Introduction; focus on building basic awareness.
- C. Decline, since profits always fall once competitors arrive.
- D. Growth; expand distribution and build brand preference against new rivals.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A laundry detergent's sales have been flat for three years, most households already buy the category, and competitors frequently cut prices. Which life-cycle stage is this?

- A. Growth.
- B. Maturity.
- C. Introduction.
- D. Decline.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A tech company launches a patented virtual-reality headset that no rival can copy for at least two years. Early buyers are enthusiasts who care little about price. The launch event was streamed to 2 million viewers. Which pricing strategy fits best?

- A. Price skimming.
- B. Price low because the stream reached 2 million viewers.
- C. Penetration pricing.
- D. Always match the lowest competitor price.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A grocery chain with 150 stores wants to know whether lowering the price of store-brand cereal causes higher sales. Its loyalty app has 3 million members. Which research approach answers the question?

- A. Focus groups to explore how shoppers feel about cereal.
- B. An experiment: cut the price in randomly chosen stores and compare sales with matched control stores.
- C. A survey asking shoppers whether they would buy more at a lower price.
- D. Email all 3 million app members about the price.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A 200-room beachfront hotel with an award-winning restaurant has 40 empty rooms tonight. The manager notes that tonight's unsold rooms can never be sold later. Which service characteristic does this describe?

- A. Perishability.
- B. Variability.
- C. Intangibility.
- D. Inseparability, because the restaurant is on site.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Customers at a hair salon say their experience depends heavily on which stylist they get. Which service characteristic is this, and what is the usual remedy?

- A. Perishability; offer off-peak discounts.
- B. Intangibility; add tangible cues like décor.
- C. Variability; standardize training and service procedures.
- D. Variability; hire one stylist to serve everyone.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A Texas barbecue-sauce maker that has used the same recipe since 1978 begins selling its existing sauces in Canada. Its CEO recently spoke at an industry conference. In the Ansoff matrix, what growth strategy is this?

- A. Product development.
- B. Diversification.
- C. Market penetration.
- D. Market development.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which move is diversification in the Ansoff matrix for a U.S. pet-food maker?

- A. Selling its current dog food in Japan.
- B. Running U.S. coupons to sell more dog food.
- C. Launching a line of human snack bars in Japan.
- D. Adding a cat treat for its U.S. customers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A bottled-water brand with a popular celebrity spokesperson cuts the plastic in its caps by 5% and relabels all bottles “Eco-Friendly — Good for the Planet.” The brand sponsors a marathon. Which assessment is most accurate?

- A. It risks greenwashing; claims should be specific and supported, such as “5% less plastic in caps.”
- B. It is sustainable marketing because any reduction justifies the label.
- C. It is fine because the celebrity endorses it.
- D. It is a positioning issue, not an ethical one.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A mid-sized outdoor-gear company ~~that sells in 18 countries~~ has already chosen young urban commuters as its customer group. It now wants those buyers to see its backpacks as the most durable option at a fair price, compared with rival brands. ~~Its ad agency is based in Portland.~~ Which STP step is this?

Target word: name the STP step **Decides:** Shaping perception relative to competitors in the target's mind.

A	Confusion set	Segmentation divides the whole market into groups.
B	Correct	Defining how the brand is perceived versus rivals is positioning.
C	Camouflage	The agency's location does not decide the step.
D	Adjacent category	Targeting was choosing urban commuters, which is already done.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A streaming service sorts all potential viewers into groups by age, household type and viewing habits before deciding whom to serve. Which STP step is this?

Target word: reverse: step from the activity **Decides:** Dividing the market into groups.

A	Inverted operation	Targeting comes after, when it picks which groups to serve.
B	Adjacent category	Positioning is about perceived image, not grouping buyers.
C	Correct	Grouping buyers by shared traits is segmentation.
D	Confusion set	Research may inform grouping, but the grouping itself is segmentation.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A snack brand ~~with a new mango flavor~~ decides to sell through convenience stores and vending machines instead of large grocery chains. ~~Its founder started the company in a college dorm.~~ Which element of the marketing mix is this decision?

Target word: classify the decision **Decides:** Choice of channels and outlets.

A	Camouflage	The flavor is background; the decision is about outlets.
B	Adjacent category	Outlet choice may affect price, but the decision itself is distribution.
C	Confusion set	Promotion is communication, not where the product is sold.
D	Correct	Channel and distribution decisions are place.

4. Answer D Concept 3

Sales of a smart-ring fitness tracker rose 80% this year, several new competitors entered, and the maker turned its first profit. ~~The product comes in four colors.~~ Which life-cycle stage is it in, and what strategy fits?

Target word: stage and strategy **Decides:** Rapid sales rise, new entrants, profits turning positive.

A	Adjacent category	Maturity has flat sales; these are rising sharply.
B	Inverted operation	Introduction has slow sales and few competitors.
C	Absolute language	Competition does not mean decline while sales are growing fast.
D	Correct	Growth is marked by fast sales gains and new competitors.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A laundry detergent's sales have been flat for three years, most households already buy the category, and competitors frequently cut prices. Which life-cycle stage is this?

Target word: reverse: stage from symptoms **Decides:** Flat sales, saturation, price competition.

A	Inverted operation	Growth has rising sales.
B	Correct	Plateaued sales and price competition define maturity.
C	Confusion set	Most households already buy; this is not a new category.
D	Adjacent category	Decline means falling sales, not flat.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A tech company launches a patented virtual-reality headset that no rival can copy for at least two years. Early buyers are enthusiasts who care little about price. ~~The launch event was streamed to 2 million viewers.~~ Which pricing strategy fits best?

Target word: choose pricing strategy **Decides:** Unique, protected product with price-insensitive early adopters.

A	Correct	High launch prices capture early adopters while the product is unique.
B	Camouflage	Audience size does not change buyers' price sensitivity.
C	Inverted operation	Suits price-sensitive markets where fast share matters.
D	Absolute language	There are no direct competitors to match.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A grocery chain with 150 stores wants to know whether lowering the price of store-brand cereal causes higher sales. ~~Its loyalty app has 3 million members.~~ Which research approach answers the question?

Target word: research design **Decides:** The question is cause and effect.

A	Confusion set	Exploratory; generates ideas, not causal proof.
B	Correct	Causal questions need experiments with controls.
C	Adjacent category	Descriptive; stated intent does not prove causation.
D	Camouflage	Promotion to app members is not research design.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A 200-room beachfront hotel ~~with an award-winning restaurant~~ has 40 empty rooms tonight. The manager notes that tonight's unsold rooms can never be sold later. Which service characteristic does this describe?

Target word: name the characteristic **Decides:** Unused capacity is lost forever.

A	Correct	Services cannot be stored for later sale.
B	Confusion set	Variability is about inconsistent quality.
C	Adjacent category	True of services, but not what lost room-nights describe.
D	Camouflage	The restaurant does not decide the characteristic.

9. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

Customers at a hair salon say their experience depends heavily on which stylist they get. Which service characteristic is this, and what is the usual remedy?

Target word: reverse: characteristic and response **Decides:** Quality differs by provider.

A	Confusion set	That addresses unused capacity.
B	Adjacent category	Addresses how hard services are to evaluate, not inconsistency.
C	Correct	Training and standards reduce inconsistency.
D	Absolute language	Unworkable; the goal is consistency across staff.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A Texas barbecue-sauce maker ~~that has used the same recipe since 1978~~ begins selling its existing sauces in Canada. ~~Its CEO recently spoke at an industry conference.~~ In the Ansoff matrix, what growth strategy is this?

Target word: name the Ansoff cell **Decides:** Existing product, new market.

A	Inverted operation	That is new products for existing markets.
B	Confusion set	Requires both a new product and a new market.
C	Adjacent category	That is selling more in the current market.
D	Correct	Existing products into a new market.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

Which move is diversification in the Ansoff matrix for a U.S. pet-food maker?

Target word: reverse: pick the example **Decides:** New product and new market together.

A	Adjacent category	Market development.
B	Inverted operation	Market penetration, the opposite corner.
C	Correct	Both the product and the market are new.
D	Confusion set	Product development.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A bottled-water brand ~~with a popular celebrity spokesperson~~ cuts the plastic in its caps by 5% and relabels all bottles "Eco-Friendly — Good for the Planet." ~~The brand sponsors a marathon.~~ Which assessment is most accurate?

Target word: ethical evaluation **Decides:** A broad green claim based on a minor change.

A	Correct	Vague claims that overstate a small change mislead consumers.
B	Absolute language	A small change does not support a sweeping claim.
C	Camouflage	An endorsement does not verify the claim.
D	Adjacent category	Misleading environmental claims are an ethics issue.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	0	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	11	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Segmentation, targeting and positioning (STP)	Segmentation divides the market into groups; targeting chooses which groups to serve; positioning shapes how the brand is perceived relative to competitors in the target's mind.	Calling the choice of an image "targeting" or the choice of a group "positioning."	Is the firm splitting the market, picking a group, or defining its image?
2	The marketing mix (4 Ps)	Product = the offering and its features; price = what customers pay; place = how it reaches customers (channels, distribution); promotion = how it is communicated.	Filing channel or distribution choices under promotion.	The decision named: features, cost to buyer, where sold, or messaging.
3	Product life cycle	Introduction (low sales, high cost), growth (rapid sales rise, competitors enter), maturity (sales plateau, price competition), decline (sales fall); strategy shifts with each stage.	Reading strong profits in a crowded, flat market as growth.	Sales trend, number of competitors and profit direction.
4	Price skimming vs. penetration pricing	Skimming starts high to capture early adopters when the product is unique and demand is price-insensitive; penetration starts low to win share quickly when demand is price-sensitive and scale lowers cost.	Using skimming in a price-sensitive market with easy imitation.	Uniqueness, barriers to copying, and how sensitive buyers are to price.
5	Marketing research design	Exploratory research generates ideas; descriptive research measures who, what and how many; causal research uses experiments to test cause and effect. Secondary data already exists; primary data is collected for the problem.	Using a survey or correlation to claim one factor causes another.	Whether the question asks what is happening or what causes it.
6	Characteristics of services	Services are intangible, inseparable from their provider, variable in quality, and perishable (unused capacity cannot be stored).	Mixing up variability (inconsistent quality) and perishability (lost capacity).	Empty seats or rooms, different staff giving different experiences, or production during consumption.
7	Ansoff growth matrix	Market penetration = existing products, existing markets; product development = new products, existing markets; market development = existing products, new markets; diversification = new products, new markets.	Calling a new geographic market product development.	Are the product and the market new or existing?

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Ethical and sustainable marketing	Environmental and social claims must be specific, accurate and verifiable; vague or exaggerated claims are greenwashing and erode trust.	Believing a green label or image is enough if the product changed a little.	Broad terms like “eco-friendly” backed by a minor change.

Course scope (public description): Marketing Management examines foundational marketing concepts. Marketing is ever-present in our daily lives and this course will help students understand how organizations use marketing activities to create value for their customers. Students will study the strategic marketing planning process and the marketing mix of product, price, place, and promotion. Students will gain knowledge about the market research process and how data are used to inform marketing decisions. Emphasis will be placed on ethical and sustainable marketing practices, along with a focus on service marketing in today’s service economy. This course will provide students with a basic marketing understanding to prepare them for specialized major courses.